

RELIGION WITHOUT GOD

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST → FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS → BUDDHISM → JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA → CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE → NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW

● SUBORDINATE EXTRA

● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g13 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST

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CAN RELIGION EXIST WITHOUT A CREATOR GOD?

RELIGION MAY ORGANISE

ULTIMATE CONCERN

SACRED VALUE

MORAL DISCIPLINE WORLDVIEW

THEISM IS SUFFICIENT FOR MANY RELIGIONS, NOT CONCEPTUALLY NECESSARY

ATHEISTIC; SILENCE, IRRELEVANCE AND DENIAL ARE DIFFERENT POSITIONS.

religion may organise

ultimate concern

sacred value

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Creator-belief is sufficient for many religions but not necessary where a sacred order, disciplined practice, community and transformation remain.

01

STAGE 01

FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS

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DENIES THAT GOD EXISTS

SUSPENDS JUDGEMENT BECAUSE KNOWLEDGE/EVIDENCE IS INSUFFICIENT

GOD IS ABSENT OR NON-CENTRAL TO THE PATH

HOLDS GOD-BELIEF HARMFUL OR FALSE IN A STRONGER EVALUATIVE

"GOD" MUST BE MADE MEANINGFUL BEFORE EXISTENCE IS DEBATED

LIFE ORGANISED WITHOUT REFERENCE TO GOD KEEP EPISTEMIC SUSPENSION

ATHEISM: denies that God exists

AGNOSTICISM: suspends judgement because knowledge/evidence is insufficient

NON-THEISM: God is absent or non-central to the path

ANTI-THEISM: holds God-belief harmful or false in a stronger evaluative sense

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Atheism denies, agnosticism suspends, non-theism makes God non-central and anti-theism adds a negative evaluation; these positions must not be merged.

02

STAGE 02

BUDDHISM

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS

DEPENDENT ORIGINATION

EIGHTFOLD PATH

NIRVĀNA NO ETERNAL CREATOR IS NEEDED; SUFFERING HAS CONDITIONED

BUDDHA REJECTS SPECULATIVE QUESTIONS WHEN THEY DO NOT CONDUCE

KARMA/ORDER FUNCTIONS LIKE HIDDEN PROVIDENCE REPLY

CAUSAL-MORAL REGULARITY IS IMPERSONAL; NO OMNIPOTENT ALLOCATOR OR CREATOR

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS → dependent origination → eightfold path → nirvāna no eternal creator is

suffering has conditioned causes, not divine decree devas may occur in cosmology but are impermanent

Buddha rejects speculative questions when they do not conduce to cessation of dukkha objection: karma/order

no omnipotent allocator or creator follows.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Buddhism is creator-independent rather than devotion-free: dependent origination, path, community and nirvana organise the religious life.

03

STAGE 03

JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA

JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA

ETERNAL JIVA/AJIVA; KARMIC MATTER; TĪRTHANKARA TEACHES, NOT CREATES

AUTHORLESS ETERNAL VEDA; RITUAL ACTION GENERATES APŪRVA; NO DIVINE

PRAKRTI EVOLVES FOR PLURAL PURUṢAS; UNCONSCIOUS TELEOLOGY WITHOUT CREATOR

IF GOD IS PERFECT, WHY CREATE? IF EMBODIED, WHO

JAINISM RETAINS WORSHIPFUL EXEMPLARS; MĪMĀMSĀ CENTRES DHARMA/RITUAL

SĀMKHYA CENTRES DISCRIMINATIVE METAPHYSICS AND KAIVALYA.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
JAINISM: eternal jiva/ajiva; karmic matter; tirthankara teaches, not creates	unconscious teleology without creator shared anti-creator pressure: if God is perfect, why create?	Sāmkhya centres discriminative metaphysics and kaivalya.
MĪMĀMSĀ: authorless eternal Veda; ritual action generates apūrva; no divine author needed	if embodied, who made body?	
SĀMKHYA: prakrti evolves for plural puruṣas	distinctions: Jainism retains worshipful exemplars; Mīmāṃsā centres dharma/ritual	

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism, Mimamsa and Samkhya relocate creation, authority, efficacy and liberation differently and are not one Indian atheism.

04

STAGE 04

CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE

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CĀRVĀKA DENIES GOD, AFTERLIFE, KARMA, VEDIC AUTHORITY AND MOKṢA

DOES IT COUNT AS RELIGION?

DOCTRINAL-HISTORICAL MEMBER OF INDIAN PHILOSOPHICAL DEBATE

YES SACRED/TRANSCENDENT/SOTERIOLOGICAL PRACTICE IN ROBUST SENSE

LARGELY NO LIMIT CASE SHOWS THAT "PHILOSOPHY WITHOUT GOD"

BUDDHISM/JAINISM BETTER PRESERVE RITUAL, COMMUNITY AND LIBERATION FUNCTIONS.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Carvaka is the limiting case: rejecting God plus sacred order, afterlife and liberation shows why philosophy without God is easier than religion without God.

05

STAGE 05

NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

"GOD IS DEAD"

COLLAPSE OF THE CHRISTIAN-METAPHYSICAL VALUE HORIZON DANGER

NIHILISM, HERD MORALITY EXPOSED, NO TRANSCENDENT GUARANTOR TASK

REVALUATION OF VALUES

LIFE-AFFIRMATION NOT A SIMPLE EMPIRICAL PROOF THAT NO DEITY

SELF-CREATED VALUES RISK ARBITRARINESS OR DOMINATION REPLY

GENEALOGY TESTS INHERITED VALUES; AFFIRMATIVE CREATION ACCEPTS RESPONSIBILITY

"GOD IS DEAD" = collapse of the Christian-metaphysical value horizon danger: nihilism, herd morality exposed

affirmative creation accepts responsibility

POST-THEISM asks what religious depth survives after classical supernatural belief.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche diagnoses a collapsed value horizon; post-theistic value creation does not by itself supply ritual, community or soteriology.

06

STAGE 06

NATURALISM AND FICTIONALISM

NATURALISM AND FICTIONALISM

RELIGIOUS NATURALISM

NATURE IS ULTIMATE; AWE, GRATITUDE, RITUAL AND ETHICS WITHOUT

PARTICIPATE IN GOD-LANGUAGE/PRACTICE WITHOUT LITERAL ONTOLOGICAL ASSENT

SEA OF FAITH

RELIGIOUS SYMBOLS SHAPE LIFE RATHER THAN REPORT A TRANSCENDENT

WORSHIP WITHOUT REAL OBJECT IS MAKE-BELIEVE; PRAYER LOSES ADDRESS

SYMBOLS AND COMMUNAL NARRATIVES CAN DISCLOSE VALUE AND TRANSFORM

RELIGIOUS NATURALISM: nature is ultimate; awe, gratitude, ritual and ethics without supernaturalism

FICTIONALISM: participate in God-language/practice without literal ontological assent

SEA OF FAITH / non-realism: religious symbols shape life rather than report a transcendent entity

prayer loses address

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Naturalism and fictionalism retain some religious functions, but sincerity, truth, transcendence and category over-breadth remain live objections.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

PYQ AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

DEFINE RELIGION BY CLUSTERED FEATURES

DISTINGUISH FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS

DEMONSTRATE BUDDHISM/JAINISM/MĪMĀMSĀ/SĀMKHYA

USE CĀRVĀKA BOUNDARY

OBJECTION ON TRUTH/OBJECT

VERDICT BY CRITERION CREATOR-BELIEF NECESSARY? NO

ULTIMATE CONCERN/RITUAL/TRANSFORMATION POSSIBLE? YES PERSONAL WORSHIP AND PROVIDENCE PRESERVED?

DEFINE religion by clustered features → distinguish four negative positions

demonstrate Buddhism/Jainism/Mīmāṃsā/Sāmkhya → use Cārvāka boundary

Nietzsche/post-theism → naturalism/fictionalism → objection on truth/object

VERDICT BY CRITERION creator-belief necessary? NO

ultimate concern/ritual/transformation possible? YES personal worship and providence preserved? often NO

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion without God is coherent, but petition, grace and providence remain specifically deity-dependent goods whose loss must be conceded.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

SUBSTANTIVE DEFINITIONS IDENTIFY RELIGION BY REFERENCE TO GODS OR

FUNCTIONAL DEFINITIONS IDENTIFY ORIENTATION, PRACTICE, COMMUNITY, MEANING OR LIBERATION.

IF CREATOR-BELIEF IS MADE NECESSARY BY DEFINITION, BUDDHISM IS

A MULTIDIMENSIONAL ACCOUNT BETTER CAPTURES DOCTRINE, RITUAL, ETHICS, EXPERIENCE

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

ADVANCED OBJECTION

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.